

Prompts

- A **prompt** is the input text you feed to an LLM
 - How much wood could a
 - How many meters are in a mile?
- The LLM then predicts the next word, repeatedly, until the predicted next word is [EOS]
- Some prompts will get better responses than others!
 - Why?

Prompt Engineering

- Can we write a prompt that is more likely to get a good response?
 - YES: Prompt engineering!
- Can we guarantee a perfect answer by engineering a prompt?
 - NO!

Prompt Engineering

- Control model behavior
- Get constrained outputs
- Higher output quality
- Automate operations

Prompt Engineering Limitations

- High sensitivity
- Common sense
- Exception handling
- Debugging

Prompt Engineering

- Template
 - Translate this sentence from English to Spanish:
- Fill in the blank
 - The first person to walk on the moon was _____
- Multiple choice
 - Which of the 3 options below is correct?

Prompt Engineering

- Instructional
 - Write a neutral-tone sales pitch in 300 words for a pair of socks
- Iterative
 - Start with a broad prompt and narrow it based on LLM's output
- Ethically aware
 - LLMs may avoid answering certain questions